sanctuary provided by Pakistan to the Haqqani Network, which has taken over management of the Taliban's military machine.

Three of the biggest tests for diplomacy and statecraft in Asia are Afghanistan, the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK), and Pakistan, the latter two being the nodes of global proliferation and terrorism. Other problems in Asia include strategic mistrust or misperception, unresolved borders and territorial disputes, competition over energy and other natural resources, and the rise of new nationalism, which has equally affected other parts of the world.

Indo–US cooperation will also be informed by events beyond the Indo-Pacific. The world is now facing greater flux than in preceding decades. It becomes hazardous in these circumstances to speak of a stable Indo-Pacific when the wider global architecture is itself unsettled. The benign international environment expected from the end of the Cold War is nowhere to be seen. Henry Kissinger wrote in 2014 that the world is in a greater state of disorder than at any time since the end of the Second World War over 70 years ago.[36] The challenge that India and the United States confront is how to create stability in the Indo-Pacific theatre at a time when the global order itself is in a state of disrepair.

The rise of China and the Indo-Pacific

The most spectacular change in Asia in the past 25 years is China's achievement in lifting a large part of its population out of poverty in a single generation.[37] Robyn Meredith observed in 2012: "China now exports *in a single day* more than it sold abroad *during the entire year* of 1978, when China began opening its economy."[38] China's transformation was particularly rapid between the years 2000 and 2015.